VALIANT VERIFICATION · METHODOLOGY

A way of knowing when “done” means “proven.”

The hard part of most work isn’t *doing* it — it’s knowing whether it was done *right*. This is a simple, universal method for making “done” mean “proven,” not “claimed.” It works the same whether you’re building a house, fixing a car, running a kitchen, or balancing the books.

1 · The problem it solves

Most people call a thing “done” the moment the person doing it stops. That’s the wrong signal — stopping and being right are different events.

The trap underneath it: **a green tick that never actually ran looks exactly like a tick that passed.** If nobody checks the checker, then “all good” and “never looked” are indistinguishable. And so the same loop repeats forever:

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS
1	Someone does the work.
2	It breaks — somewhere nobody expected.
3	Apologies are made, a fix is applied.
4	The fix breaks something else. Back to step 2.

That loop is not laziness — it is what happens when nothing is **forced to prove itself**. The fix is to make the proof structural, not a matter of good intentions.

2 · The five rules

RULE 1 **The checklist is locked.**

Before you call the job finished, there is a fixed list that *must* be checked — and nobody gets to skip one because they’re tired or “pretty sure.” If a check is skipped, the job fails. Skipping a check can never be allowed to look like passing one.

RULE 2 **Test the test itself.**

Every check has to be shown working once, on purpose: cause a real failure and watch the check catch it. Because a smoke detector you've never set off is just a plastic box on the ceiling. A check that has never gone "fail" might be doing nothing at all.

RULE 3 **Different eyes.**

The person who signs off the work is not the person who did it. The electrician does not grade his own wiring; the builder does not inspect his own roof. Maker and checker are two different people, on purpose.

RULE 4 **Mistakes become rules.**

When something goes wrong, you don't just fix it and move on. You write down what happened and add a new line to the checklist that would have caught it. From then on that line is on every job — so you never pay for the same expensive mistake twice.

RULE 5 **Show your work.**

Every result names *who* did the check, *that it actually ran*, and *what "failed" would have looked like*. No anonymous "all good." No name, no evidence, no definition of failure — then it doesn't count.

3 · What it adds up to

RULE	THE PROMISE IT KEEPS
1	Nothing slips through unexamined.
2	Every check genuinely works — proven, not assumed.
3	Nobody marks their own homework.
4	The same mistake never happens twice.
5	Every "done" comes with its receipt.

Together they change one sentence: instead of **"done means I stopped,"** you get **"done means it's proven."**

4 · Where it applies

The same five moves fit any trade where the word “done” is supposed to carry weight:

TRADE	WHAT “PROVEN” LOOKS LIKE THERE
Building a house	Wiring, plumbing, roof and foundations each signed off — by someone other than the person who did them.
Fixing a car	The fault is reproduced before the fix, and re-checked after — not “should be right now.”
Running a kitchen	A food-safety routine that gets spot-checked, and any incident adds a permanent new line to it.
A hospital checklist	A surgical team that reads the list aloud, every time, no exceptions — because a skipped step is the failure.
Balancing the books	Numbers that reconcile to the penny, with the person who checked named on the page.

Said plainly: this method does not make the work easier — it makes the *claim* trustworthy. It is the difference between “we’re pretty confident it’s right” and “here is the receipt showing it was checked, that the check works, and who checked it.”

This is the methodology behind Valiant Verification — a trust layer for work that must be proven before it is believed. This document is an internal explainer; it is not published on the site.